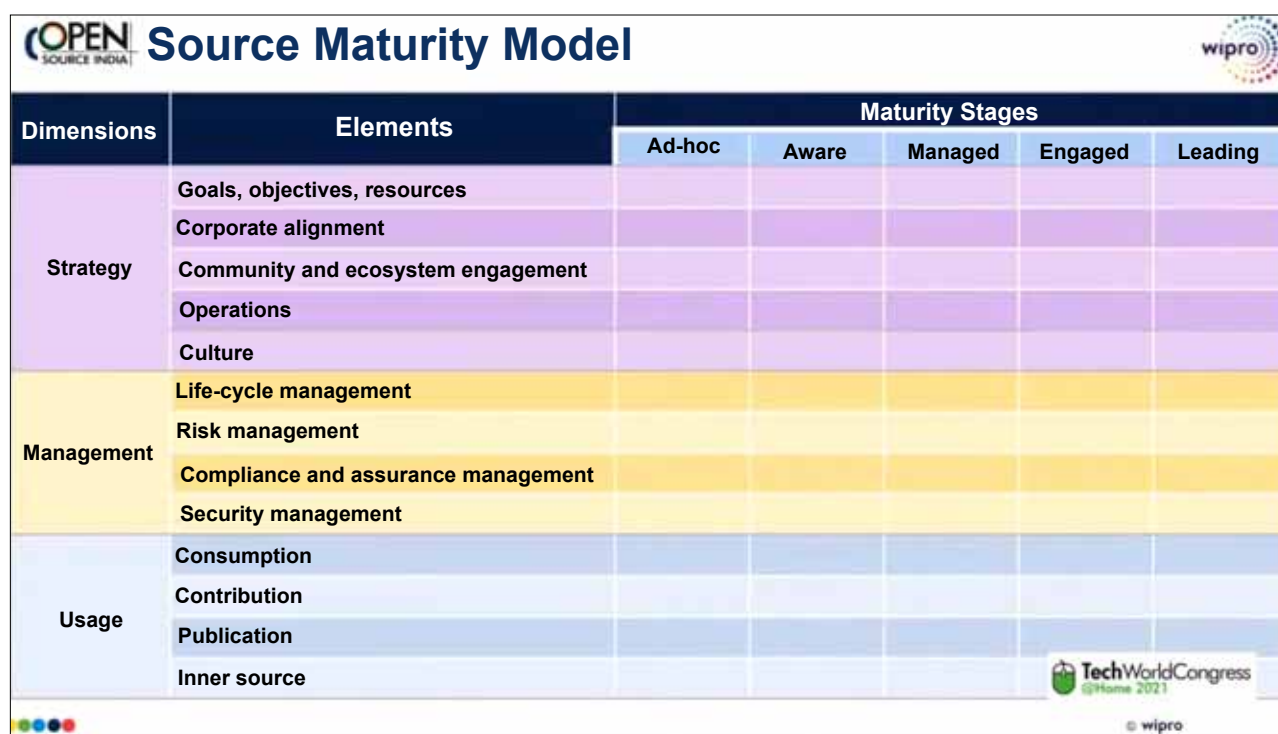




Dimensions	Elements	Maturity Stages				
		Ad-hoc	Aware	Managed	Engaged	Leading
Strategy	Goals, objectives, resources					
	Corporate alignment					
	Community and ecosystem engagement					
	Operations					
	Culture					
Management	Life-cycle management					
	Risk management					
	Compliance and assurance management					
	Security management					
Usage	Consumption					
	Contribution					
	Publication					
	Inner source					

Figure 1: The open source maturity model

Needless to say, open source is no longer an option for scaling a business. Rather, you'd be lagging far behind if your business is yet to expose itself to the open source model. However, open source is not all roses and sunshine. In any business model, there will be troughs, and open source is no different. Aiming to scale a business through open source does come with the associated risks, but minimising these is what we need to strive at.

Especially if your organisation is largely foreign to the idea of open source, making a shift can be a daunting proposition. Does that mean you opt out? Definitely not! This is where an open source maturity model comes to your rescue.

What is an open source maturity model?

The open source maturity model is a tool that helps organisations make informed decisions about the most effective way to use open source to meet their corporate objectives.

Understanding the open source maturity model requires one to get acquainted with the idea of the open source maturity curve, which indicates the extent to which an organisation is adopting open source models and practices into its daily workings. The degree to which an organisation defers adopting these puts it on different stages of the maturity model.

Knowing an organisation's position on the open source maturity model helps it understand how adept it is at leveraging open source, helping it to create a roadmap to reach its goals while reducing any constraints. In its essence, the open source maturity model is a guide for organisations to map out their open source journey without wasting effort.

The open source maturity process

There are a set of steps that an organisation has to follow to understand its current position

with respect to adopting and utilising open source.

Complete an online survey: The first step is to take an online survey. The respondents should ideally be working across various departments within the organisation to have a broader and clearer picture of the stage they are in. This survey could include questions that would assess if, and how, an organisation utilises open source in its current operations.

Review output: Once the survey is completed, an output is generated, which gives the current picture of the organisation on the open source maturity curve. A visualisation, showing the present state of maturity, is also provided.

Current state analysis and future planning: The findings of the survey and the qualitative responses can then be used to analyse the current state the organisation is in with respect to open source maturity. Based on this, a roadmap can be created. Planning for the future is determined by interviewing the organisation and its people.